



NUMBER - 6 BEAUTIFUL BACKHANDS



Movement Skills

Activity

- In groups of four, from a central base, players practice movements to shadow both forehand and backhand strokes in the backhand rear court.
- For example:
 - Split, pivot, hop (around the head).
 - Split, chasse, pivot (overhead backhand).
- After shadowing the stroke, the player run forwards to the net, chasses along the net and rests.
- Players complete a relay, with the next player starting when the previous one reaches the net.

Easier

- Start from a central base and focus on the pivot on the non-racket foot to turn players away from the net.
- Play music with a rhythm to help with the timing of the steps.

Harder

- Have one player act as the 'caller' who may call "HIGH" or "LOW" to trigger a shadow of an appropriate shot for a higher or flatter trajectory shot respectively.

Top Coaching Tips

Emphasise that both forehand and backhand strokes are options when the shuttle is in the backhand rear court.

Focus on a well-timed split to enable both movement patterns to be considered.

Racket Skills

Activity

- In pairs on a half-court, players start by shadowing a backhand flat drop shot from the rear court (from the backhand corner). Players turns to shadow and observe each other.
- Players focus on racket carriage and creating an appropriate shape.
- After five minutes of shadowing, progress to players working in pairs with Player A providing a single shuttle feed (flat and into the backhand rear corner) for Player B to turn and play a flat/fast backhand drop back into the court.
- Complete 10 shots before swapping roles.

Easier

- Spend more time on the shadow element.
- Adjust the feed by moving closer and reducing feed distance.
- Spend time hitting tap ups with a bevel grip first.

Harder

- Feed deeper and flatter into the corner.
- Use a throw down spot as a target to hit and set a target height for the shot to travel over the net.
- Add a shadow movement before playing the shot.

Top Coaching Tips

Track the shuttle and feel comfortable allowing it to travel to the side and slightly behind.

Use a bevel grip which (to be adjusted based on the feed).

Carry the racket in a relaxed position until releasing to hit.



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Rally Skills

Activity

- In pairs on half-courts, players need to achieve the target number set for their half-court (each target number is different)
- At one end of the hall on the half-court, a pair must achieve a rally of 10, the next pair 12, the next pair 14 and so on.
- If a pair reaches their target before the next half-court they shout 'BUMP' and demote the pair 'above them' whilst promoting themselves. They must now attempt the next target number.
- Each time a pair completes the 'top' court target they get a point and return to the start (everyone moves up).
- Each rally should be sequential (starting with Player A):
 - High serve
 - Clear
 - Drop Shot
 - Lift
 - Clear
 - Repeat

Easier

- Reduce the target number required.
- Simplify the shot sequence.
- Allow freedom to play any shots.

Harder

- Set extra rules e.g. the serve must go to the back tramlines.
- Increase the target numbers used across all courts.
- Set a time limit.

Top Coaching Tips

Raise awareness of the importance of recovery.

Discuss the use of height in rallying to provide more time.

Split before moving.

Matchplay Skills

Activity

- In pairs, players play a game of half-court singles. With bonus point options below:
 - If a player forces their opponent to play an overhead backhand they gain a bonus point.
 - If a player successfully plays an overhead backhand they gain two bonus points.
 - If a player completes a rally without having to play an overhead backhand they gain a bonus point.
 - If a player wins a rally in which they played an overhead backhand they gain three bonus points.

Easier

- Playing full court singles will provide more opportunities to force overhead backhand strokes to be played/attempted.
- Start the game with a predictable rally (e.g. low serve, net shot, net shot, lift to backhand rear court).

Harder

- To get the bonus points for an overhead backhand stroke, it must force opponent to take the shuttle below net height.
- To get a bonus point for forcing an overhead backhand, a player must win the rally.

Top Coaching Tips

Consider how the scoring system affects the choices the players make and tweak them accordingly. Changing combinations of bonus options can have significant impacts.



Click here to see this activity in action

